

CENTRE FOR HERITAGE STUDIES

Odisha · Established 2008

Preserving the Past, Inspiring the Future

OFFICIAL WEBSITE CONTENT WRITEUP

Sections A through H — Ready for Web Design

Regd. No. 22663/253 of 2007–2008 · Bhubaneswar, Odisha
June 2026



CENTRE FOR HERITAGE STUDIES

Reg. No- 22663/253 of 2007-2008

How to Use This Document

This document contains the complete website content writeup for the Centre for Heritage Studies (CHS), Odisha — covering all eight sections (A through H). Each section is written at a level of detail suitable for direct use by your web designer and content team.

For each section you will find:

- › High-level introductory paragraph for the section landing page
- › Detailed writeup for every sub-page within the section
- › Suggested image and video placements, clearly marked
- › Pull quotes suitable for display typography or banners

The writeup draws directly from CHS's founding documents, registration details, major activity records, project proposals, and the digital presence plan prepared by the team. All facts, names, and affiliations are sourced from the documents shared.

Notes on Image/Video placements are marked in shaded boxes throughout. These are suggestions for your designer — replace with actual CHS photographs, field footage, and event recordings as they are collected.

SECTION A

Home Page

The Home Page is the front door of CHS's digital presence. It must communicate — within seconds — who CHS is, what it stands for, and why it matters. Since CHS is entering the digital world for the first time after seventeen years of active work, the homepage carries the additional responsibility of making up for lost time: it must immediately signal that this is a serious, established, and deeply credible institution.

Image/Video Suggestion: Full-width hero photograph — a dramatic wide-angle image of Konark Sun Temple, Ratnagiri Buddhist Complex, or the Chilika coastal belt at dawn. The image should feel timeless and convey the weight of history.

Hero Banner — Opening Statement

Odisha carries within its soil, stone, and living traditions one of the most extraordinary cultural legacies in the world. Thousand-year-old temples rise from forested hills. Ancient ports lie buried beneath coastal sands. Sacred rituals, crafts, and performing arts passed down through generations continue to breathe life into communities across the state.

The Centre for Heritage Studies (CHS), Odisha exists to ensure that this legacy is not lost — that it is documented, understood, conserved, and shared with the world.

Preserving the Past, Inspiring the Future

Image/Video Suggestion: Overlay the tagline on the hero image in large, elegant typography. Below the tagline, place three call-to-action buttons: 'Explore Heritage Sites', 'Read Our Research', and 'Join CHS'.

About CHS — Snapshot Strip

Established on 19 January 2008 and registered as a society under Regd. No. 22663/253 of 2007–2008, the Centre for Heritage Studies brings together an extraordinary community of archaeologists, historians, anthropologists, conservation professionals, architects, researchers, and heritage enthusiasts united by a single purpose: the protection and promotion of Odisha's cultural heritage.

Over seventeen years, CHS has conducted archaeological explorations and excavations, documented over a thousand heritage sites, organised national conferences, delivered landmark lectures, and collaborated with some of India's foremost heritage institutions — all in service of a state whose cultural wealth remains vastly underrepresented in the national and global conversation.

Image/Video Suggestion: A horizontal strip of four to five thumbnail photographs showing the range of CHS's work — a field survey team, a conference gathering, an excavation site, a heritage monument, and a community outreach programme.

Impact Numbers — Heritage at a Glance

Let the numbers speak. After seventeen years of active work, CHS's record stands as testimony to its commitment. Present these figures as animated counters on the page:

- › 1,000+ heritage monuments and archaeological sites documented across Odisha
- › 4,000 monuments targeted under the ongoing comprehensive documentation project across all 30 districts
- › 82+ distinguished life members from across India's archaeological and heritage fraternity
- › 14+ major projects, conferences, excavations, and outreach initiatives since 2008
- › 30 districts of Odisha to be covered under the current documentation programme
- › Multiple national and international collaborations including IGNCA, ASI, Utkal University, Deccan College Pune, and UCLA

Image/Video Suggestion: Design the numbers section as bold display typography against a warm cream or stone-textured background. Each number should appear as a large counter with a short label beneath it.

Featured Heritage Site

Each week, CHS highlights one of Odisha's extraordinary heritage sites — from the globally celebrated to the quietly forgotten. From the magnificent Sun Temple at Konark to an unrecorded mound near the banks of Chilika Lake, every site carries a story that deserves to be told.

This week's featured site links to the full site profile in the Heritage Knowledge Portal, inviting visitors to explore Odisha's heritage one story at a time.

Image/Video Suggestion: A large card with a photograph of the featured site, its name, district, one-line description, and a 'Read More' button. Rotate this content monthly or weekly.

Latest News & Events

CHS is a living institution. Workshops, lectures, field surveys, publications, and public programmes continue to mark its calendar. This section keeps visitors informed of what CHS has most recently undertaken and what lies ahead.

Image/Video Suggestion: Three or four card-style previews of recent news items or upcoming events, each with a thumbnail image, headline, date, and a short excerpt. Link each card to the full article in the News & Events section.

Partner Institutions

Over the years, CHS has built meaningful collaborations with some of India's most distinguished heritage institutions. These partnerships have made possible the surveys, excavations, conferences, and documentation projects that define CHS's track record.

CHS has worked alongside the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA), New Delhi; the Archaeological Survey of India (ASI); the Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Manav Sangrahalaya (IGRMS), Bhopal; the Department of Ancient Indian History, Culture and Archaeology at Utkal University; Deccan College, Pune; the Department of Anthropology, University of California Los Angeles (UCLA); and the Department of Culture, Government of Odisha.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A horizontal logo strip of partner institution logos against a light background. Keep it clean and professional.*

SECTION B

About CHS

The About section is where credibility is built. For a professional body like CHS — whose members include former Directors and Superintending Archaeologists of the ASI, former Vice Chancellors, and scholars affiliated with some of India's and the world's leading academic institutions — this section must give every name, affiliation, and achievement its due weight.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Section entry image: a formal group photograph of CHS members at a conference or seminar, or a photograph of the founding gathering. If unavailable, use an image of the most senior members at a recent event.*

Our Story

The Centre for Heritage Studies was born out of a conviction shared by a group of Odisha's most distinguished archaeologists and heritage scholars: that the state's extraordinary cultural legacy deserved a dedicated institution — independent, professionally driven, and committed to rigorous documentation, conservation, and public engagement.

On 19 January 2008, CHS was formally registered as a society under Regd. No. 22663/253 of 2007–2008, bringing together historians, archaeologists, anthropologists, conservation professionals, architects, and heritage enthusiasts under one roof. The founding members brought with them decades of experience from the Archaeological Survey of India, Odisha's state archaeology department, and some of India's premier academic institutions.

From the very beginning, CHS set itself apart by combining scholarly rigour with practical action. Within weeks of its registration, the Centre co-organised a national workshop on Intangible Cultural Heritage at Konark — one of Odisha's most iconic World Heritage Sites. In the months that followed, it undertook its first major documentation project, recording over a thousand monuments and heritage sites across Odisha for the IGNCA National Databank on Indian Art and Culture.

That spirit of purposeful work has continued without interruption. Across seventeen years, CHS has conducted archaeological explorations along the Puri–Konark–Chilika coast, carried out excavations at prehistoric and early historic sites in Khurda and Puri districts, published research, organised national conferences, and run an ongoing lecture and outreach programme that has brought some of the world's leading heritage scholars to Bhubaneswar.

Today, CHS stands at a significant threshold. The organisation is undertaking the most ambitious documentation project in its history — a comprehensive survey of approximately 4,000 heritage monuments and sites across all thirty districts of Odisha. It is simultaneously building its digital presence, creating a platform that will make the knowledge and expertise accumulated over seventeen years accessible to researchers, students, policymakers, communities, and heritage enthusiasts across the globe.

Heritage is not merely a record of the past; it is a living resource that shapes identity, strengthens communities, and inspires future generations.

Image/Video Suggestion: A timeline graphic showing key milestones: 2008 — registration and first workshop; 2008–10 — IGNCA National Databank project; 2008–09 — Puri-Konark-Chilika exploration; 2013 — Harirajpur excavation; 2014–15 — Talapada excavation; 2015–16 — Ostapur excavation; 2016 — National Conference; 2019 — Brainstorming Session; 2020–24 — Lecture series; 2025 — Ashutosh Memorial Lecture.

Mission, Vision & Commitment

Our Mission

To document, preserve, interpret, and popularize the diverse cultural heritage of Odisha while fostering research, collaboration, education, and public participation in heritage conservation.

Our Vision

To establish Odisha as a global centre for heritage knowledge, research, conservation, and cultural innovation through the integration of traditional scholarship and emerging digital technologies.

Our Commitment

To preserve, document, interpret and promote the diverse cultural heritage of Odisha through research, education, innovation, and community participation for the benefit of present and future generations.

CHS believes that heritage belongs to everyone. The monuments of Odisha — its temples, Buddhist complexes, fortifications, ancient ports, and living traditions — are not the exclusive preserve of specialists and academics. They are the shared inheritance of every citizen of the state, of India, and of the world. Making that inheritance known, accessible, and protected is the work CHS has committed itself to.

Image/Video Suggestion: Place the Mission, Vision, and Commitment as three distinct cards or panels on the page, each with a relevant icon and a short pull quote. Use a warm stone or terracotta background.

Core Areas of Work

CHS's work spans a wide and interconnected range of disciplines, reflecting the multidisciplinary nature of heritage conservation itself. The Centre's twelve core areas of work represent not just what CHS does, but what it believes heritage science requires:

- › **01.** Archaeological Survey, Exploration and Excavation
- › **02.** Heritage Documentation and Inventory Creation
- › **03.** Conservation and Heritage Management
- › **04.** Historical and Cultural Research

- › **05.** Architectural Documentation
- › **06.** Digital Heritage and 3D Documentation
- › **07.** Intangible Cultural Heritage Studies
- › **08.** Museum and Interpretation Planning
- › **09.** Heritage Education and Public Outreach
- › **10.** Cultural Tourism and Heritage Trails
- › **11.** Community-Based Heritage Conservation
- › **12.** Research Publications and Knowledge Dissemination

Image/Video Suggestion: Present the twelve areas as a visual grid of cards, each with a simple icon (trowel, camera, open book, globe, etc.) and the area title. A subtle hover effect showing a one-line description of each area would add interactivity.

Our Objectives

The Centre's objectives reflect the full scope of what is needed to truly serve Odisha's heritage — from the ground up, through research and into public life:

- › To undertake archaeological surveys, explorations, and excavations to discover, study, and interpret cultural remains that illuminate the historical and cultural development of Odisha.
- › To promote the conservation, protection, interpretation, and presentation of both tangible and intangible heritage — including monuments, archaeological sites, historic structures, traditional settlements, cultural landscapes, crafts, performing arts, rituals, folklore, and living traditions.
- › To identify, survey, document, map, and create comprehensive inventories of cultural properties and heritage resources across Odisha using both traditional and digital methodologies.
- › To establish and maintain a comprehensive digital repository of heritage resources, research findings, photographs, maps, manuscripts, reports, oral histories, audiovisual archives, and digital heritage assets.
- › To encourage scholarly research in archaeology, history, anthropology, architecture, conservation, museum studies, heritage management, and cultural tourism, and to disseminate such knowledge through publications, seminars, conferences, and digital platforms.
- › To foster awareness and appreciation of heritage among students, local communities, and the wider public through heritage walks, lectures, seminars, workshops, exhibitions, and outreach programmes.
- › To develop a vibrant professional networking hub for archaeologists, historians, anthropologists, architects, conservation professionals, museum specialists, researchers, students, and heritage practitioners.
- › To collaborate with government departments, universities, research institutions, museums, cultural organizations, and international agencies for technical expertise, supervision of archaeological works, research collaboration, and resource mobilisation.
- › To promote the use of emerging technologies such as GIS mapping, photogrammetry, 3D scanning, virtual reality, and augmented reality for heritage documentation, conservation, interpretation, and public engagement.

- › To support responsible heritage management and sustainable cultural tourism initiatives that contribute to the preservation of heritage while generating educational, social, and economic benefits for local communities.
- › To encourage active participation of communities, institutions, and citizens in documenting, safeguarding, and promoting cultural heritage — recognising that heritage conservation is a shared responsibility.

Office Bearers

CHS is guided by an exceptional group of scholars and professionals whose combined experience spans the full breadth of archaeological and heritage science in India. Their affiliations with the Archaeological Survey of India, Utkal University, the National Monuments Authority, and other premier institutions lend the Centre its distinctive authority and credibility.

- › Advisor — Prof. K.K. Basa, Chairman, National Monuments Authority, Government of India
- › President — Prof. Sadasiba Pradhan, Former Professor, Department of Ancient Indian History, Culture & Archaeology, Utkal University
- › Vice-President — Prof. Sanjaya Acharya, Former Professor, Department of Ancient Indian History, Culture & Archaeology, Utkal University
- › Secretary — Dr. J.K. Patnaik, Former Superintending Archaeologist, Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)
- › Joint Secretary — Dr. S.K. Patnaik, Former OTS-I (S) & Secretary, Orissan Institute of Maritime and South East Asian Studies (OIMSEAS)
- › Treasurer — Sri Bijay Kumar Das, Retired Senior Administrative Officer, Archaeological Survey of India (ASI)

Image/Video Suggestion: Photograph of each office bearer with name, designation, and institutional affiliation below. Use a clean card layout with a soft cream background. Formal portraits preferred.

Executive Members

The Executive Council of CHS brings together a remarkable assembly of scholars whose contributions to Indian and Odishan heritage studies are widely recognised. Their collective expertise spans archaeology, anthropology, history, architecture, conservation, and academic administration.

- › Prof. K.S. Behera — Former Vice-Chancellor
- › Dr. Asutosh Patnaik — Director, Public Health
- › Prof. S.P. Rath — Former Vice-Chancellor
- › Prof. P.K. Das — Former Professor of Anthropology
- › Prof. L.S. Nigam — Eminent Scholar, Raipur
- › Prof. B.K. Tripathy — Vice-Chancellor, G.M. University
- › Prof. Rabi Mohanty — Eminent Archaeologist and Academician, Pune
- › Dr. S.B. Ota — Former Joint Director General, Archaeological Survey of India
- › Dr. D.N. Dimiri — Former Joint Director General, Archaeological Survey of India

› Shri A.K. Patel — Former Director, Archaeological Survey of India

Image/Video Suggestion: Consider a brief illustrated biography for each executive member: a small portrait, their area of expertise, and one key contribution to Odishan heritage studies. This elevates the page from a list to a portrait of the institution's intellectual depth.

Membership

Beyond its office bearers and executive council, CHS is home to a large and growing community of 82 life members drawn from across India. Historians, archaeologists, anthropologists, conservation experts, architects, researchers, academicians, administrators, and heritage enthusiasts — the membership of CHS reflects the full spectrum of expertise required to understand and protect Odisha's heritage.

This multidisciplinary composition is one of CHS's greatest strengths. When the Centre undertakes a documentation project, it draws not only on archaeological expertise but also on architectural analysis, anthropological fieldwork, historical research, and community knowledge. That breadth is what makes CHS's work holistic rather than narrowly specialist.

CHS warmly welcomes applications for life membership from heritage professionals, researchers, academics, students, and individuals with a sincere commitment to the conservation of Odisha's cultural legacy. To join the CHS community, visit our Membership page.

Image/Video Suggestion: A photograph of a CHS gathering or annual meeting showing the breadth of the membership — a diverse group of scholars and professionals. A 'Become a Member' button should appear prominently near the end of this section.

CHS & Government Institutions

CHS occupies a unique and important position within Odisha's heritage ecosystem. As an independent, professionally driven organisation, CHS is free to conduct research and documentation without the institutional constraints that often limit government bodies. Yet it works in close and productive partnership with government agencies — providing technical expertise, research support, and informed guidance that directly strengthens official conservation and management efforts.

The Centre has collaborated extensively with the Department of Culture, Government of Odisha, including co-organising the National Conference on Archaeological Research and Conservation Studies in 2016 and the Brainstorming Session on Archaeological Studies in 2019. It has worked with the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts on the National Databank on Indian Art and Culture project. It has carried out field surveys under licences from the Director General of the Archaeological Survey of India. And it is currently working in close consultation with the State Government of Odisha on the comprehensive documentation of 4,000 heritage monuments across all thirty districts.

This relationship — independent yet collaborative, scholarly yet practically engaged — is what makes CHS an effective and trusted partner in Odisha's heritage governance

SECTION C

Heritage Knowledge Portal

The Heritage Knowledge Portal is the intellectual heart of the CHS website — and the resource that most clearly distinguishes this platform from any other heritage organisation's website. It is designed as a living, growing, publicly accessible archive of Odisha's tangible and intangible cultural heritage: a place where a researcher in Bhubaneswar, a student in Delhi, a policymaker in Brussels, or a member of the Odishan diaspora in the United States can find detailed, reliable, and visually rich information about heritage sites, monuments, living traditions, and cultural landscapes from across the state.

A growing archive of heritage sites, monuments, archaeological remains, inscriptions, manuscripts, cultural landscapes, traditional practices, and community knowledge systems from across Odisha.

Image/Video Suggestion: Portal homepage: a search bar prominently centred, with category filter buttons below it (Temples, Buddhist Sites, Forts, Coastal Heritage, Archaeological Sites, Intangible Heritage, Tribal Heritage). A subtle map of Odisha in the background with glowing site markers.

Temples & Shrines

Odisha is renowned worldwide as one of the great centres of temple architecture. From the awe-inspiring Konark Sun Temple — a UNESCO World Heritage Site and one of the supreme achievements of medieval Indian craftsmanship — to the sacred Jagannath Temple at Puri and the exquisitely carved Lingaraja Temple at Bhubaneswar, the state's temple heritage spans nearly fifteen centuries of continuous artistic and architectural tradition.

But the story of Odisha's temples extends far beyond these celebrated landmarks. Across the thirty districts of the state, thousands of temples — many of them unprotected, unrecorded, and unknown beyond their immediate communities — stand as testimony to the depth and continuity of Odishan religious and artistic culture. Some are maintained by local communities with great devotion. Others stand in various stages of neglect, their stone carvings eroding, their histories unwritten.

CHS's Heritage Knowledge Portal documents both: the celebrated and the unknown, the protected and the at-risk. Each temple profile includes its location, architectural style, historical period, current condition, and CHS's documentation records.

Image/Video Suggestion: A gallery-style grid of temple photographs — include both iconic sites and lesser-known ones to signal the breadth of the database. Each card links to the individual site profile.

Buddhist Heritage Sites

Long before Odisha was known for its temples, it was one of the great centres of Buddhism in ancient India. The Buddhist complex at Ratnagiri, Udayagiri, and Lalitgiri — known collectively as the 'Diamond Triangle' of Buddhist heritage — represents one of the most significant concentrations of

Buddhist monastic and artistic tradition in the subcontinent. At Ratnagiri, an imposing ninth-century stupa and elaborate monastery ruins speak of a thriving centre of Buddhist learning that attracted scholars and pilgrims from across Asia.

CHS documents and advocates for the protection of Odisha's Buddhist heritage — sites that are globally significant but sometimes locally overlooked in favour of the state's more prominent Hindu temple tradition. The Portal brings these sites their deserved visibility through detailed profiles, photographic documentation, and links to excavation and research reports.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Atmospheric photographs of the Ratnagiri stupa, Udayagiri monastery ruins, and sculptural fragments. A short introductory video of the Buddhist Triangle sites would be highly effective here.*

Forts, Palaces & Historic Structures

Odisha's political and military history is written in stone across its landscape. Forts built by Gajapati kings, palaces of feudatory chiefs, residences of colonial administrators, and historic civic structures together form a layer of built heritage that reflects the state's complex political evolution across centuries.

CHS documents these structures with the same rigour it brings to temple and Buddhist site documentation — recording their history, current physical condition, threats from encroachment and neglect, and the management context in which they exist.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Photographs of historic fortifications or palace structures in Odisha. If specific CHS-documented sites are available, use those with proper captions.*

Water Heritage & Coastal Sites

Odisha's relationship with water is ancient, deep, and defining. The state's 480-kilometre coastline, its great inland lake at Chilika, and its network of rivers have sustained human settlements, trade networks, and cultural traditions for thousands of years. Odisha was one of ancient India's great maritime civilisations — a fact evidenced by references in Buddhist texts to Odishan sailors crossing the Bay of Bengal to Southeast Asia, and by the archaeological remains of ancient port cities buried along its coast.

CHS has been at the forefront of documenting this maritime and water heritage. In 2007–2008, the Centre conducted extensive archaeological surveys of sites along the Chilika coastal zone — at Thora, Anuli, Orei, Anasara, Tangi, and surrounding areas — identifying previously unrecorded archaeological remains. In collaboration with Utkal University, it undertook a major licensed exploration of the coastal belt between Puri and Konark, extending to the banks of Chilika Lake. The ancient port site of Manikapatna in Puri district, which CHS supported for detailed documentation, stands as evidence of Odisha's once-thriving maritime economy and its connections to the wider world of Indian Ocean trade.

The Water Heritage section of the Portal brings together all of CHS's documentation of coastal, riverine, and maritime heritage sites, linking archaeological findings with historical context.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Panoramic photographs of the Chilika coastal zone, the Puri-Konark coast, and the Manikapatna site. A short drone video of the coastline would be compelling for this section.*

Prehistoric & Archaeological Sites

Before the temples were built, before the Buddhist monasteries flourished, before the ports began to trade — Odisha was home to some of the earliest human settlements in the Indian subcontinent. The state's prehistoric and early historic record, much of which remains to be fully explored and understood, holds the key to understanding the deep roots of Odishan civilisation.

CHS has made significant contributions to this understanding through its excavation programme. At Harirajpur near Jatni, a prehistoric excavation conducted in 2013 in collaboration with Utkal University and Deccan College Pune revealed important evidence of the region's earliest human occupation. At Talapada in Khurda district, excavations carried out in 2014–15 in partnership with Deccan College and the University of California Los Angeles yielded significant data on settlement history and material culture. At Ostapur, also in Khurda district, the 2015–16 field season under the direction of Prof. K.K. Basa and Prof. R.K. Mohanty contributed further to the reconstruction of cultural sequences in the region.

Each of these sites has a dedicated profile on the Portal, with links to the full excavation reports available in the Research & Publications section.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Field photographs from excavation sites — trenches, ceramic finds, stratigraphic sections. These are authentic CHS materials and should be used directly. Academic photographs of artefacts would add scholarly weight.*

Intangible Cultural Heritage

A temple is not only stone and mortar. It is also the community of priests and devotees who maintain its rituals. A craft tradition is not only the objects it produces but the knowledge, skill, and identity carried by the craftsman. An oral tradition is not only words but a living system of memory, meaning, and belonging.

UNESCO's frameworks for safeguarding Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) recognise what CHS has always believed: that the living dimensions of heritage — the festivals, the performing arts, the crafts, the rituals, the oral histories, the traditional knowledge systems — are as important and as endangered as the physical monuments themselves. Often, when a community loses its ICH, the physical monument it once sustained loses its meaning too.

CHS has been engaged with Intangible Cultural Heritage documentation from its earliest days. The Centre co-organised a National Workshop on the Documentation of Intangible Cultural Heritage at Konark in February 2008, in collaboration with the Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Manav Sangrahalaya, Bhopal. This workshop brought together heritage professionals and cultural practitioners to develop methodologies for documenting and safeguarding India's living traditions.

The ICH section of the Heritage Knowledge Portal documents Odisha's extraordinary range of living heritage: the Chhau and Odissi dance traditions, the Pattachitra painting tradition of Raghurajpur, the Dongria Kondh's knowledge of forest ecology, the ritual traditions associated with the Jagannath culture, the boat-building traditions of coastal fishing communities, and much more.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Photographs and short video clips of Odisha's living heritage — Pattachitra artists at work, Odissi performance, tribal festivals, traditional crafts. Video is particularly important for this section as it captures the 'living' quality of ICH in a way photographs cannot.*

Tribal Heritage

Odisha is home to 62 Scheduled Tribes — the highest number of any state in India. The heritage of these communities encompasses ancient settlement traditions, distinctive architectural forms, unique relationship with the natural landscape, complex ritual systems, rich oral literatures, and material cultures of great diversity and sophistication.

This heritage is both precious and precarious. Development pressures, displacement, and the disruption of traditional community structures threaten tribal heritage at a speed that documentation has struggled to match. CHS recognises the urgency of this challenge and includes tribal heritage as a dedicated focus area within the Heritage Knowledge Portal.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Respectful, dignified photographs of tribal heritage — traditional architecture, material culture, community gatherings. Avoid any imagery that exoticises or exploits. Caption all photographs fully.*

The Digital Heritage Map

At the centre of the Heritage Knowledge Portal is the Digital Heritage Map of Odisha — an interactive, GIS-enabled map that gives every visitor a visual overview of the state's documented heritage, site by site, district by district.

Every documented heritage site in the CHS database appears on the map as a marker, colour-coded by category (temple, Buddhist site, fort, coastal/water heritage, prehistoric site, ICH location, tribal heritage) and by conservation status (documented and safe, at risk, critically endangered). Visitors can filter the map by district, category, era, and status, and click on any marker to access the full site profile.

In its current phase, the map presents the sites documented by CHS and its partners. As the comprehensive 4,000-monument documentation project across all thirty districts progresses, the map will grow to become one of the most complete digital heritage atlases of any Indian state. Future phases will integrate LiDAR survey data, photogrammetry outputs, drone footage, and — eventually — augmented reality and virtual tour features that allow users to experience heritage sites from anywhere in the world.

Explore the heritage of all thirty districts of Odisha. Every marker tells a story. Click to discover it.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A full-width interactive map embed, or a compelling screenshot of the map with site markers visible across Odisha's districts. Include a short instructional text below: 'Use the filters above to explore by category, district, or conservation status.'*

SECTION D

Projects

Every claim CHS makes about Odisha's heritage is backed by fieldwork. The Projects section documents the actual work — the surveys, excavations, documentation exercises, and collaborative initiatives that constitute CHS's contribution to the understanding and preservation of Odisha's cultural legacy.

Since its establishment in 2008, CHS has undertaken projects funded by and in partnership with the Government of India's premier cultural bodies, the Archaeological Survey of India, leading Indian universities, and international academic institutions. Each project page provides full details of the project's objectives, methodology, team, findings, and significance.

Image/Video Suggestion: A grid of project cards showing the project title, a representative photograph, year, and a short description. Filter buttons allow sorting by type (Excavation / Documentation / Survey / Conference) and status (Completed / Ongoing / Proposed).

Flagship Project: Comprehensive Documentation of Odisha's Heritage

This is the most ambitious project in CHS's history — and arguably one of the most significant heritage documentation exercises ever undertaken in Odisha.

Resolved at a meeting of the Centre on 2 September 2025 and to be financially supported by the Government of Odisha, the project aims to comprehensively document approximately 4,000 tangible heritage monuments and sites across all thirty districts of Odisha within a period of three years. No documentation effort of this scale has previously been attempted in the state.

What makes this project genuinely distinctive is its dual mandate. The first objective is comprehensive documentation of Odisha's tangible heritage — the physical monuments, archaeological sites, historic structures, and cultural landscapes that constitute the visible record of the state's civilisational history. The second objective, equally important, is the documentation of the intangible heritage associated with these physical sites: the rituals, community traditions, oral histories, living practices, and cultural meanings that give the monuments their living significance.

This holistic approach — treating tangible and intangible heritage as two dimensions of a single reality — is in full alignment with UNESCO's international frameworks for heritage conservation and marks a significant advance in how Odisha's heritage will be understood and managed.

The project is led by Project Director Prof. Sadasiba Pradhan, President of CHS and Former Professor of Archaeology at Utkal University. Five project co-ordinators, each responsible for six districts, bring their combined experience from the Archaeological Survey of India, Utkal University, and Odisha State Archaeology to bear on the fieldwork:

- › Dr. J.K. Patnaik — Former Superintending Archaeologist, ASI
- › Dr. Sunil Patnaik — Former Secretary, OIMSEAS
- › Dr. A.K. Patel — Former Director, ASI
- › Dr. K.P. Padhy — Former Superintending Archaeologist, ASI
- › Dr. Aswini Satpathy — Former Superintendent, Odisha State Archaeology

The project's deliverables include detailed heritage inventories, site documentation reports, digital databases and archives, GIS-based heritage mapping, high-resolution photographic records, conservation recommendations, and a comprehensive digital data architecture designed for long-term maintenance and public accessibility.

Complementing the documentation fieldwork, advanced Photogrammetry and LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging) surveys will be undertaken through specialised agencies under the auspices of the Government of Odisha, in consultation with CHS. These technologies will produce highly accurate three-dimensional digital records of monuments and sites — records that will serve conservation planning, disaster risk management, academic research, and virtual heritage applications for decades to come.

For the first time, Odisha's heritage will be seen whole — documented not merely as a collection of individual sites, but as a living cultural landscape of extraordinary depth and diversity.

Image/Video Suggestion: A map of Odisha showing all 30 districts divided among the five project coordinators. Field photographs of documentation teams at work — ideally images of a team member recording a monument with survey equipment, a GPS device, or a camera.

National Databank on Indian Art & Culture (IGNCA)

One of CHS's earliest and most significant contributions to heritage documentation, this project was undertaken on behalf of the Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA), New Delhi — one of India's premier cultural institutions.

Under the project, CHS systematically documented both protected and unprotected archaeological and heritage sites across Odisha. More than a thousand monuments and archaeological sites from different districts of the state were surveyed, photographed, and recorded in structured data formats. The completed database was submitted to IGNCA and made publicly accessible through the IGNCA's official digital platform.

This project represents the foundation upon which CHS's documentation expertise was built, and the data it generated remains a valuable resource for researchers working on Odisha's heritage.

Image/Video Suggestion: A representative selection of photographs taken during the IGNCA documentation project — variety of monument types, districts, and documentation activities. Credit photographs appropriately.

Archaeological Exploration: Puri–Konark–Chilika Region

In collaboration with the Post Graduate Department of Ancient Indian History, Culture and Archaeology at Utkal University, and after obtaining the necessary exploration licence from the Director General of the Archaeological Survey of India, CHS undertook a major archaeological exploration of a rich and historically significant region of coastal Odisha.

The exploration covered the coastal belt between Puri and Konark — one of the most archaeologically promising and culturally significant stretches of coastline in eastern India — as well as the banks of Chilika Lake. The jurisdictions covered included Puri Sadar, Brahmagiri, Satyabadi, Delang, Pipili, Balipatna, Nimapara, Kakatpur, Gop, Tangi, and Babbpur across Puri and Khurda districts.

The exploration identified and documented several previously unrecorded archaeological remains and cultural sites. A trial excavation was conducted near Konark to investigate the cultural sequence of the area, yielding valuable data on the settlement history of this iconic region.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Maps of the exploration area with site locations marked. Field photographs of the exploration — the coastal landscape, team members conducting surveys, identified site features.*

Excavations: Harirajpur, Talapada & Ostapur

CHS's excavation programme has generated important new knowledge about the prehistoric and early historic occupation of Odisha's heartland — the Khurda and Puri districts that surround Bhubaneswar.

At Harirajpur near Jatni (2013), conducted in collaboration with the Department of Anthropology at Utkal University and Deccan College, Pune, under the guidance of Prof. K.K. Basa, excavations revealed significant evidence of prehistoric human occupation in the region — pushing back the known cultural sequence and adding new dimensions to the understanding of Odisha's earliest inhabitants.

At Talapada, Khurda district (2014–15), Prof. Rabindra Kumar Mohanty led a major excavation in collaboration with Deccan College, Pune, and the Department of Anthropology, University of California Los Angeles (UCLA). The international dimension of this collaboration speaks to the global significance of the archaeological data being recovered from Odisha's soil.

At Ostapur, Khurda district (2015–16), excavations and explorations of the surrounding region under the joint directorship of Prof. K.K. Basa and Prof. R.K. Mohanty added further evidence to the emerging picture of settlement patterns and cultural development in this archaeologically rich area.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Field photographs from these excavations: trench profiles, team members at work, finds in situ. Photographs of significant artefacts would be excellent here. Label each with site name and year.*

Manikapatna Ancient Port Documentation

Manikapatna, situated on the shores of Chilika Lake in Puri district, is one of the most evocative archaeological sites in coastal Odisha. Ancient textual sources and archaeological evidence suggest that it was a significant port and settlement — a node in the ancient maritime trade networks that once linked Odisha to Southeast Asia, Sri Lanka, and the wider Indian Ocean world.

CHS provided financial and technical assistance to Prof. R.K. Mohanty of Deccan College, Pune, for the preparation of a detailed archaeological report on Manikapatna, including site drawings, photographic documentation, and ceramic assemblage analysis. The study contributes significantly to the understanding of Odisha's maritime heritage and the ancient trade connections that once made this coastline one of the busiest in South Asia.

Image/Video Suggestion: Photographs of the Manikapatna site, its location on Chilika Lake, and any documented artefacts or ceramic finds. A map showing Manikapatna's position in ancient Indian Ocean trade routes would add geographical and historical context.

SECTION E

Research & Publications

The scholarly output of CHS reflects the intellectual calibre of its membership. Research and Publications is where that output lives — accessible to researchers, policymakers, students, journalists, and members of the public who want to go deeper than a heritage site profile and engage with the evidence, analysis, and argument that underpins CHS's understanding of Odisha's heritage.

This section brings together everything CHS has produced and supported: peer-reviewed research papers, excavation and field survey reports, conservation studies, books and monographs, conference proceedings, and the documentation databases generated through major projects.

Access to scholarly articles, excavation reports, heritage studies, research papers, field reports, monographs, conference proceedings, and academic resources.

Image/Video Suggestion: An image of a researcher at work — reading a document in a field setting, studying artefacts, or working with maps. A secondary image of a publication or report cover would anchor the scholarly identity of this section.

Research Papers & Articles

The members of CHS have contributed to the scholarly understanding of Odisha's heritage across a wide range of disciplines: the archaeology of Odisha's prehistoric period, the architectural history of Kalinga temple tradition, the maritime archaeology of the Odishan coast, the anthropology of tribal communities, the conservation of Buddhist heritage, and much more.

This repository makes those contributions discoverable and accessible. Papers can be searched by author, subject area, publication year, and site or topic — making it a practical resource for researchers across disciplines.

Image/Video Suggestion: A clean, well-designed searchable list of research papers with author, title, year, and a 'Download PDF' button for each. A filter sidebar by subject and author.

Excavation & Field Survey Reports

Every excavation CHS has conducted or supported has generated detailed technical reports — the primary records of what was found, where it was found, and what it means. These reports are the irreplaceable foundation of archaeological knowledge about the sites in question.

The following reports are available for download in this section:

- › Archaeological Exploration of the Puri–Konark–Chilika Region — field season 2008–09
- › Archaeological Exploration and Survey of the Chilika Coastal Zone — 2007–08 (Thora, Anuli, Orei, Anasara, Tangi)
- › Excavation Report: Harirajpur, Khurda — 2013
- › Excavation Report: Talapada, Khurda District — field season 2014–15
- › Excavation Report: Ostapur, Khurda District — field season 2015–16
- › Ceramic Assemblage Report: Manikapatna Ancient Port Site, Puri District

Image/Video Suggestion: A typeset report cover design for each report, displayed as a card in a grid. Each card shows the title, lead author, year, and a 'Download' button.

Conference Proceedings

CHS has organised several landmark national events that brought together the leading minds in Indian heritage studies. The proceedings of these conferences represent an important body of scholarly literature on Odisha's archaeological and heritage challenges and opportunities.

- › National Workshop on Documentation of Intangible Cultural Heritage, Konark — 29 February 2008 (in collaboration with IGRMS, Bhopal)
- › National Conference on Archaeological Research and Conservation Studies, Bhubaneswar — May 2016 (in collaboration with Department of Culture, Government of Odisha)
- › Brainstorming Session on Archaeological Studies, Bhubaneswar — March 2019 (in collaboration with Department of Culture, Government of Odisha)

Proceedings from these events are available for download. They represent a significant contribution to the documentation of India's evolving understanding of heritage conservation best practices.

Image/Video Suggestion: Photographs from each conference — speakers at the podium, audience in session, and any group photographs. Conference posters or banners in the background will help contextualise the images.

Books & Monographs

The members of CHS have authored and contributed to a significant body of published literature on Odishan heritage. This section catalogues books, monographs, and edited volumes produced by CHS members, with details of publisher, year, and where to obtain copies.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Book cover images displayed as a digital bookshelf. Each entry links to purchase information or a downloadable version where rights permit.*

Heritage Inventories & Documentation Databases

The most extensive documentary output of CHS's work is its heritage inventory data — the structured records of over a thousand sites compiled for the IGNCA National Databank project, and the growing dataset being compiled under the current 4,000-monument documentation initiative.

Access to these datasets is available at different levels. Summary records for all documented sites are publicly accessible through the Heritage Knowledge Portal. Detailed technical records, including site drawings, ceramic analyses, and conservation assessments, are available to registered researchers upon request.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A visual representation of the database — a sample site record form showing fields like site name, district, GPS coordinates, period, architectural style, conservation status, photograph reference, and notes. This gives visitors an understanding of the rigour and depth of CHS's documentation methodology*

SECTION F

Events & Activities

CHS is not only a research body — it is a community of scholars and heritage advocates who believe that knowledge must be shared, discussed, and put to work. Since its establishment, the Centre has maintained an active programme of events, bringing together archaeologists, historians, policymakers, students, and members of the public in the shared pursuit of heritage understanding and conservation.

From intimate heritage walks along Bhubaneswar's temple trail to national conferences attended by leading scholars from across the country, CHS's events programme reflects the full spectrum of its mission: scholarly, public, educational, and advocacy-driven.

Image/Video Suggestion: A collage of event photographs — a conference hall with speakers, a heritage walk group at a site, an online webinar screenshot, students at a workshop. This should convey the variety and vitality of CHS's programme.

The Ashutosh Memorial Lecture Series

The Ashutosh Memorial Lecture Series was inaugurated by CHS in February 2025 as a premier platform for scholarly discourse on archaeology, heritage studies, and cultural conservation. The series is designed to honour the memory and contributions of a distinguished scholar of Odishan heritage, and to bring the highest level of academic engagement to Bhubaneswar on an annual basis.

The inaugural lecture was delivered by Prof. Dilip Kumar Chakrabarti, one of the most distinguished archaeologists of his generation and a former Professor of South Asian Archaeology at the University of Cambridge, United Kingdom. The event attracted eminent archaeologists, historians, academicians, and researchers from across India, and established the series as one of the most significant annual heritage events in eastern India.

Future editions of the Ashutosh Memorial Lecture will continue to invite leading scholars to address audiences in Bhubaneswar on subjects of significance to Indian and global heritage studies. Information on upcoming lectures and registration will be posted on this page.

Exploring the Past, Preserving the Present, and Inspiring the Future.

Image/Video Suggestion: A formal photograph of Prof. Dilip Kumar Chakrabarti delivering the inaugural lecture. A wide photograph of the audience. The event banner or backdrop if visible. A short video clip of the lecture, if available, would be exceptional content for this page.

National Conferences & Seminars

CHS has established itself as a convener of scholarly dialogue at the national level. Its conferences and seminars have brought together the leading voices in Indian heritage studies to examine emerging challenges, share new research, and develop collective responses to the complex problems of heritage conservation in a rapidly changing society.

Among the most significant of these events:

The National Workshop on Documentation of Intangible Cultural Heritage, Konark (February 2008) was organised in collaboration with the Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Manav Sangrahalaya, Bhopal, at the World Heritage Site of Konark — an appropriate setting for a gathering devoted to the interplay of tangible monuments and their living cultural contexts. The workshop brought together specialists in ICH documentation from across India to develop methodologies that remain relevant today.

The National Conference on Archaeological Research and Conservation Studies (May 2016) in Bhubaneswar, organised jointly with the Department of Culture, Government of Odisha, provided a platform for presenting new research, discussing conservation challenges, and fostering interdisciplinary dialogue on the future of heritage protection in India.

The Brainstorming Session on Archaeological Studies (March 2019) in Bhubaneswar facilitated a focused conversation among leading scholars and practitioners on emerging research priorities, new methodologies, and the particular challenges of archaeological conservation in Odisha.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Photographs from each conference — speakers, audience, venue, group photographs. If available, video recordings of key sessions are an outstanding resource for this page and the YouTube channel.*

Lecture Series & Webinars (2020–2024)

In the years between 2020 and 2024, CHS maintained its commitment to public and professional education through a sustained programme of lectures and webinars — delivered both online and in person — on diverse aspects of archaeology, history, culture, heritage management, and conservation.

These programmes brought to Bhubaneswar (and to online audiences across India and beyond) some of the country's most distinguished archaeologists and heritage scholars, creating opportunities for students, researchers, professionals, and interested members of the public to engage with current thinking in heritage studies.

The full archive of these lectures — including recordings where available, speaker biographies, and lecture summaries — is accessible through this page.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A clean grid of past lecture cards, each with the speaker's photograph or portrait, lecture title, date, and a 'Watch Recording' or 'Read Summary' button. A filter by year and topic would enhance usability.*

Heritage Walks

Bhubaneswar — India's temple city — is one of the most extraordinary places in the world to walk through history. Within a relatively compact area, dozens of temples spanning nearly fifteen centuries of architectural evolution stand as living testimony to the creativity and devotion of Odishan civilisation.

CHS organises guided heritage walks that bring students, researchers, tourists, and curious citizens into direct encounter with this built heritage. Led by expert archaeologists and historians from the CHS community, these walks go beyond the standard tourist itinerary to explore the historical, artistic, and cultural dimensions of the sites visited.

Heritage walks are open to all. Upcoming walk schedules are posted on this page. Schools, colleges, and cultural organisations can arrange customised walks for groups by contacting CHS directly.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Photographs of a heritage walk in progress — a guide explaining a temple feature to a group, participants looking at architectural details, the group walking through a heritage precinct. These images convey the accessibility and warmth of CHS's public engagement work.*

Exhibitions

Heritage exhibitions organised or supported by CHS bring Odisha's extraordinary cultural legacy into public spaces — schools, museums, cultural centres, and public halls — in forms accessible to audiences who may never visit an archaeological site or read a research paper.

Through carefully designed displays, photographic documentation, artefact replicas, and interpretive panels, CHS exhibitions translate the scholarship of its members into engaging public experiences. Information on past exhibitions and upcoming events is available on this page.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Photographs from exhibition venues — display panels, visitors engaging with the exhibition, and any opening ceremony gatherings. These images convey the public-facing dimension of CHS's work.*

SECTION G

Gallery & Media

Heritage is a visual subject. The stone carvings of Konark, the atmospheric ruins of Ratnagiri, the sweep of the Chilika coastline at dusk, the careful hands of a field archaeologist brushing away centuries of sediment — these images carry a power that no amount of prose can fully replicate.

The Gallery & Media section is where CHS's visual archive lives. It is both a public resource and a statement about the organisation's work — evidence of the places visited, the people engaged, and the knowledge generated across seventeen years of active heritage documentation.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Gallery homepage: a full-width mosaic of high-quality heritage photographs with a search bar and category filters (Heritage Sites / Excavations / Events / Field Documentation / Aerial / Portraits). Clean, minimal layout that lets the images speak.*

Photo Gallery

The CHS photo archive spans the full range of the organisation's activities: field documentation of heritage sites across all thirty districts, archaeological excavations from prehistoric mounds to coastal sites, national conferences and seminars, heritage walks and public outreach events, and the living cultural traditions that give Odisha's monuments their meaning.

All photographs in the gallery are captioned with the site name, district, year, and photographer credit. High-resolution downloads are available to registered researchers, educators, and media personnel upon request.

Photographs are organised into the following collections:

- › Heritage Sites — Temples, Buddhist Complexes, Forts, Coastal Sites, Prehistoric Sites
- › Excavations — Harirajpur (2013), Talapada (2014–15), Ostapur (2015–16), Puri-Konark-Chilika Exploration
- › Field Documentation — Surveys, documentation teams, GIS mapping, photogrammetry
- › Events — National conferences, lectures, workshops, heritage walks, exhibitions
- › Living Heritage — Intangible Cultural Heritage, tribal traditions, craft practices

Image/Video Suggestion: *A masonry-style gallery grid with varied image sizes — larger for iconic heritage site photographs, smaller for field and event images. A lightbox viewer when a photograph is clicked. Watermark all images with the CHS logo to protect copyright.*

Video Archive

Video brings heritage to life in ways that no other medium can. The CHS video archive brings together field documentation footage, event recordings, expert interviews, and short heritage films — all hosted on the CHS YouTube channel and embedded here for easy access.

The archive currently includes recordings from the CHS lecture and webinar series (2020–2024), the 1st Ashutosh Memorial Lecture by Prof. Dilip Kumar Chakrabarti (February 2025), and field documentation footage from CHS's major survey projects.

As CHS's documentation programme advances, the video archive will grow to include site walkthroughs, expert interviews at excavation sites, documentary films on threatened heritage, and recorded proceedings from national events. Visitors are invited to subscribe to the CHS YouTube channel to receive notifications of new uploads.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Embedded YouTube video player for the Ashutosh Memorial Lecture as the featured video. A grid of video thumbnails below, each with title, speaker/subject, and date. A 'Subscribe on YouTube' button.*

Media Coverage

CHS's work has attracted attention from print, broadcast, and digital media. This section archives news coverage, feature articles, television appearances, and digital media mentions that document the public recognition of CHS's contributions to Odisha's heritage.

The media archive also serves as a resource for journalists and content creators seeking background information on CHS and its work. A media kit — including the CHS logo, standard organisational description, and contact details for media enquiries — is available for download on this page.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A timeline-style layout of media coverage items, each with the publication or broadcaster's name, headline, date, and a link to the original article or recording.*

SECTION H

Get Involved

Heritage conservation is not the exclusive responsibility of specialists, government agencies, or well-funded institutions. It is a shared responsibility — one that requires the participation of communities, professionals, students, institutions, and concerned individuals across society. CHS has always believed this, and the Get Involved section reflects that belief in concrete and practical terms.

Whether you are a professional archaeologist wishing to contribute your expertise to a documentation project, a student of history seeking mentorship and fieldwork experience, an institution looking for a technical partner for a heritage conservation initiative, or a concerned citizen who simply cares about the future of Odisha's cultural legacy — there is a place for you in the CHS community.

We invite you to explore, learn, contribute, collaborate, and help build a stronger future for Odisha's cultural heritage.

Image/Video Suggestion: An inviting, warm image of a diverse group of people engaged with heritage — a student sketching a temple, a researcher with an elderly community member, a volunteer helping at a survey site. The message should be: this work belongs to everyone.

Membership

Membership of CHS is an investment in Odisha's heritage — and a connection to one of the state's most distinguished communities of heritage scholars and professionals. As a life member, you become part of an institution with seventeen years of active fieldwork, national-level advocacy, and scholarly publishing behind it — and decades of ambition ahead.

CHS currently has 82 life members drawn from across India, including some of the country's most eminent archaeologists, historians, anthropologists, and heritage professionals. Membership is open to individuals who share the Centre's commitment to the documentation, conservation, and promotion of Odisha's cultural heritage.

As a member of CHS, you will:

- › Be part of a distinguished community of heritage scholars and professionals from across India
- › Receive invitations to CHS's exclusive events, conferences, lectures, and field visits
- › Have access to CHS's research archive, documentation databases, and member publications
- › Be eligible to participate in CHS's documentation and research projects
- › Contribute to the governance and direction of the Centre through participation in general body meetings
- › Have your expertise listed in the CHS Member Directory, accessible to researchers, institutions, and government agencies seeking specialist input

Life membership is available to individuals from all relevant disciplines — archaeology, history, anthropology, architecture, conservation, museum studies, cultural tourism, and heritage management. Heritage enthusiasts with a serious commitment to the cause are also warmly welcomed.

To apply for membership, please complete the online form below or contact the CHS Secretariat directly.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A photograph of a CHS membership event or annual gathering. A 'Apply for Membership' button that links to the online form. A simple two-column layout showing membership benefits on one side and the application form on the other.*

Volunteer Programme

CHS's ambitious documentation programme — covering 4,000 heritage monuments across all thirty districts of Odisha — requires committed, energetic, and capable volunteers who can support the field teams in their documentation work.

Volunteers with CHS gain invaluable hands-on experience in heritage documentation methodology, archaeological survey techniques, GIS data collection, photographic documentation, and oral history recording. They work alongside leading heritage professionals in field conditions that cannot be replicated in a classroom.

CHS welcomes volunteers from backgrounds in archaeology, history, architecture, anthropology, geography, digital mapping, photography, and other relevant disciplines. A minimum commitment of ten field days per year is requested of volunteers. CHS provides training, supervision, and certification of volunteering hours.

To register your interest in volunteering, please complete the volunteer registration form on this page.

Image/Video Suggestion: *Action photographs of volunteer activities — field surveys, photographic documentation, engagement with local communities. Convey the hands-on, experiential nature of the volunteer programme.*

Internship Programme

CHS offers structured internships for students of archaeology, history, architecture, conservation, anthropology, geography, digital heritage, and related fields. An internship with CHS offers an experience that goes beyond the theoretical: direct engagement with heritage documentation methods, mentorship from senior archaeologists and heritage professionals, and the satisfaction of contributing to a body of knowledge that will shape how Odisha's heritage is understood and protected.

Internships are structured around CHS's active projects and can be tailored to the student's discipline and interests. Interns may be involved in field documentation, archival research, digital data

management, GIS mapping, report writing, event organisation, or outreach programme support — depending on CHS's current needs and the intern's background.

CHS issues a certificate of internship upon satisfactory completion and, where appropriate, can provide letters of recommendation for students pursuing further study or professional positions in the heritage sector.

Applications for internships are accepted on a rolling basis. Students interested in an internship with CHS are invited to submit a brief expression of interest, a curriculum vitae, and a statement of what they hope to contribute and learn.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A photograph of a young student or intern engaged in fieldwork, studying a heritage site, or working with data. This page should feel aspirational and welcoming for students.*

Collaborate with CHS

CHS is a natural partner for institutions that wish to engage with Odisha's heritage in a rigorous, professional, and ethically grounded manner. The Centre has a proven track record of successful collaboration with some of India's most distinguished academic and cultural institutions, and with international partners including UCLA.

CHS welcomes collaborative proposals from:

- › Universities and academic departments in archaeology, history, architecture, anthropology, environmental studies, and related fields
- › Government departments and cultural agencies at the state and national level
- › Museums, cultural organisations, and heritage management bodies
- › International research institutions and heritage organisations
- › Funding agencies and philanthropic foundations with an interest in cultural heritage
- › Media organisations and content producers seeking authoritative partnership for heritage-related projects

Collaborative arrangements with CHS can take a variety of forms: joint research and documentation projects, co-organised events and conferences, technical advisory relationships, data-sharing agreements, or formal memoranda of understanding. CHS is open to discussing the form of collaboration that best serves the shared purpose.

To initiate a conversation about collaboration, please contact the CHS Secretariat through the [Contact page](#).

Image/Video Suggestion: *A photograph representing institutional partnership — two professionals reviewing documents together at a heritage site, or a formal signing ceremony. The logos of CHS's existing partner institutions could be shown here as well.*

Heritage Education Corner

Odisha's heritage belongs, above all, to its young people. The temples, Buddhist sites, coastal sites, and living traditions that CHS works to document and protect are not museum pieces — they are the living inheritance of the next generation. Helping young Odians understand, appreciate, and take pride in that inheritance is one of CHS's deepest commitments.

The Heritage Education Corner provides educational resources for school and college students:

- › Introductory guides to Odisha's major heritage categories — written in accessible language for students at different levels
- › Illustrated timelines of Odishan civilisational history from prehistoric times to the present
- › Heritage quiz — test your knowledge of Odisha's monuments, traditions, and historical figures
- › Reading lists — curated recommendations for students who want to go deeper
- › Resources in Odia — key materials available in Odia language for school-level engagement
- › Recordings of CHS lectures suitable for student audiences

Schools and colleges wishing to incorporate CHS's resources into their curriculum or to invite CHS members for talks and heritage walks are encouraged to contact the Centre directly.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A bright, inviting design for this sub-page — slightly more colourful than the rest of the site. Photographs of students engaging with heritage sites, a heritage quiz interface mockup, and illustrated heritage icons.*

Donate & Support CHS

CHS is a registered, non-profit organisation whose work depends on the generosity of individuals, institutions, and organisations who believe that Odisha's cultural heritage deserves to be protected.

Financial support from donors enables CHS to:

- › Fund field documentation in districts where government or institutional project funding is unavailable
- › Support young researchers and students through fellowships and internship stipends
- › Produce and distribute publications and educational materials
- › Organise public lectures, heritage walks, and outreach events
- › Develop and maintain the digital platforms that make CHS's knowledge accessible to the world

Specific campaigns through which supporters can contribute include: Adopt a Monument (funding the complete documentation of one heritage site), Support a Survey (funding a field survey team for a day, a week, or a season), and Fund a Lecture (supporting the costs of bringing a distinguished scholar to Bhubaneswar for a public lecture).

All donations to CHS are applied directly to the work of heritage documentation and conservation. For information on tax treatment of donations, please consult the relevant tax authorities or contact the CHS Treasurer.

Image/Video Suggestion: *A simple, dignified donation page — not aggressive or transactional, but warm and mission-driven. A photograph of a heritage site that donations are helping to document or protect. Clearly labelled options for different donation amounts with descriptions of what each enables.*

Centre for Heritage Studies (CHS), Odisha

Documenting Heritage · Connecting Knowledge · Inspiring Conservation

Regd. No. 22663/253 of 2007–2008 · Bhubaneswar, Odisha